Thank you for choosing to be a buddy! 💛
Your role is to provide gentle encouragement and support to survivors of self-harm through monthly mail. This guide explains what is expected, boundaries, and tips for creating meaningful letters and small surprises.

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1. Your Role

As a buddy, you will:

- Send **one letter per month** to your assigned survivor
- Include optional small items like **stickers, keyrings, bracelets, or small trinkets** that fit in an envelope
- Offer **support and encouragement**, not therapy or professional advice
- Maintain **anonymity** if desired (you can use a nickname)

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2. Boundaries

To keep everyone safe and comfortable:

- **Do not share graphic or triggering content** (no descriptions of self-harm)
- **Do not try to act as a therapist**
- Respect privacy. **Do not share survivors' personal info**
- Keep your letters **gentle, kind, and hopeful** without toxic positivity
- Avoid pressure. Your letter should **encourage, not judge**
- Please avoid including religious content as everyone has their own beliefs

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3. Letter & Mail Tips

- **Tone:** warm, non-judgmental, friendly, hopeful
- **Content ideas:**
    - Uplifting quotes or poems

  - Personal stories of resilience (avoid trauma dumping)
  - Positive affirmations or reminders
  - Creative touches: small drawings, stickers, or tiny trinkets
- **Length:** You can make it as short or long as you like. Recommended length is one page.
- **Delivery:**
  - Physical mail: send to the provided locker or address
  - Digital mail: send via email if chosen

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4. Practical Tips

- **Plan ahead:** set reminders to write and send your letter
- **Check your materials:** make sure any trinkets fit in the envelope
- **Be consistent:** try to send mail every month as agreed
- **Respect timing:** survivors may receive mail at different times and this is okay

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5. Safety & Support

- If you ever feel unsure or overwhelmed, reach out to the project coordinator and 01moremonth@gmail.com
- Remember, you are not responsible for "fixing" anyone's struggles
- Keep a **personal support system** for yourself as well

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6. Encouragement for Buddies

Your letters have **real impact**. Even a few kind words can help someone make it through a month. 💛

- Focus on **small, achievable encouragements**
- Celebrate **survivor milestones**, no matter how small

- Gentle reminders that **one more month is possible**

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7. Sample Letter Idea

Hi there,
I just wanted to send you a little note to say that I'm thinking of you. I hope this month has brought some calm and kindness your way. Keep going! You are doing better than you know.

You mentioned that reading brings you calm. I like journalling about the books I read that way I get to write my thoughts out without having to focus on my feelings. Sometimes it helps me to imagine myself as a character from one of my books so that I know that there is a happy ending.

Here's a sticker I thought you might like.

Remember there is a stranger out there who believes in you and sees that you are strong.

Sending lots of light and love

Naz